

The Promotion Conversation Planner

Stop guessing what the next level requires.

A practical guide to understanding how advancement works in **your** organization, preparing for a useful conversation with your manager, and leaving with a clearer promotion roadmap.

01 / THE ROLE

What title or level am I working toward?

What does that role own that I do not own today?

What changes in scope, decision-making, leadership or accountability?

02 / THE EXPECTATIONS

What would my manager need to see from me?

What outcomes matter most at that level?

Are there formal competency expectations, or is the process mostly informal?

03 / THE GAP

Where am I already operating at the next level?

Where is there still a genuine gap?

What opportunity would allow me to demonstrate it?

04 / THE DECISION

Who recommends the promotion - and who approves it?

Is there a calibration process? When are decisions typically made?

Are promotions affected by budget, headcount, structure or business conditions?

05 / THE EVIDENCE

What business results can I point to?

Where has my scope increased?

What problems am I solving now that I was not solving 12 months ago?

Who beyond my manager has seen that impact?

THE QUESTION TO ANSWER

If I were promoted tomorrow, what evidence would make that decision feel obvious rather than aspirational?

PAGE 2 / PREPARE THE CONVERSATION

Turn the conversation into a plan.

The goal is not to walk into a 1:1 and demand a title. It is to create clarity around what the next level requires, where the gaps are, what evidence matters, and what happens next.

01 / WHAT I WANT TO SAY

MY OPENING

"I'd like to talk about what it would take for me to move toward _____."

Why I'm raising it now:

The scope/results I believe demonstrate growth:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

What I want clarity on:

02 / QUESTIONS TO ASK

Choose the questions most relevant to your situation.

- What would you need to see from me to be confident I'm operating at the next level?
- Where do you see the biggest gap between how I'm operating today and what you'd expect at that level?
- What scope or responsibility would give me an opportunity to demonstrate that?
- How are promotion decisions made here - and who else is involved?
- What timing or business conditions affect whether a promotion can happen?
- If I delivered X, Y and Z, would that put me in a strong position?
- When should we review progress again?

03 / BUILD THE BUSINESS CASE

A promotion is not only about whether you have worked hard. Build the case for why greater scope, responsibility or authority makes sense for the organization.

AREA	TODAY	NEXT-LEVEL EVIDENCE
Scope		
Business Impact		
Decision-Making		
Leadership		
Stakeholder Influence		
Ownership		

WHAT PROBLEM WOULD PROMOTING ME SOLVE FOR THE BUSINESS?

Think beyond "I deserve it." Consider organizational need: ownership, capability, leadership, succession, growth, authority or decision-making.

04 / WHAT WE AGREED

Complete this after the conversation.

Three things I need to demonstrate next:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

New scope/opportunities I'll take on:

Who needs visibility into this work:

What success will look like:

Next review date:

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